Manom Marriage Custom and Dowry

Resource Identifier: CULT-CUST-004

English Translation: Customary Tangkhul Marriage Rites

Category: Custom | Subcategory: Marriage

Village / Region: Ukhrul | Dialect: Ukhrul

Contributor / Source: Tangkhul Clan Exogamy Custodians (Documented in Horam 1977)

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Seasonal Timing / Occasion: Winter and post-harvest marriage season

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Ethnographic Summary & Context:

Exogamous clan marriage system requiring formal negotiation between families, presentation of handwoven shawls (Manom), brass gong gifts, and communal feast.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Manom kashakli shim khani ngarumda leikashi kashung."

"Haora kala Chonkhom chikatlaga shanao kaphali masot."

"Varewui ningli kashak thotna, thot kachungli mashimanmara."

English Translation & Meaning:

"Through the Manom marriage covenant, two clans unite in sacred mutual kinship."

"Presenting prestigious Haora and Chonkhom shawls, the bride is honored with reverence."

"Covenanted under the divine sight of the Creator, this bond endures through the generations."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

1. Verification of clan exogamy (marriage within the same paternal clan is strictly forbidden).
2. Formal delegation of groom’s elders carrying rice wine to propose marriage to the bride’s parents.
3. Agreement on dowry gifts (Manom), including handwoven shawls, brass gongs, and livestock.
4. Wedding feast hosted by both families with community blessing prayers.
5. Bridal escort to the groom’s household followed by ceremonial entry rites.

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

Bride and Groom, Clan Elders of both families, Village Community

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